Interest expense / GDP, 2026 against 2036, under four joint cases: all nine countries

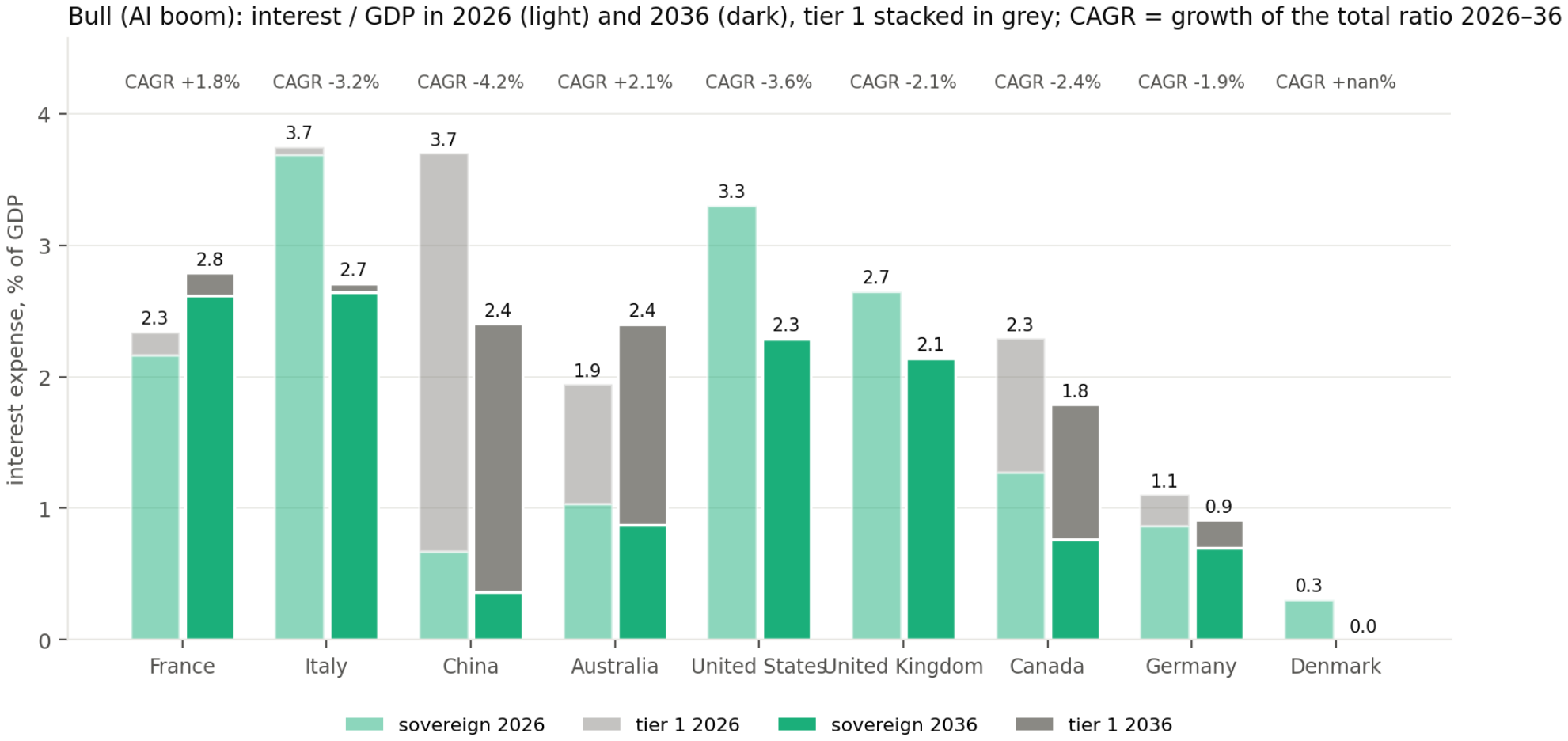
Each case moves every lever together; the base case is simply market pricing. **Bull, an AI boom then disinflation, in two phases.** Phase 1 (2027–30) is the capex boom: the curve sits on market forwards, nominal growth runs 1 pt above the country's base with inflation still 3–4%, the revenue harvest takes the primary balance to a surplus by 2030 and tier 1 keeps its middle settings. Phase 2 (2031 on): the buildout is done, disinflation arrives and the central bank cuts; the curve glides over 2031–32 to a low terminal level held through 2036 (US 2.0 / 2.2 / 3.0 / 3.5 at 1, 2, 10 and 30 years; France's 10-year spread over Bunds tightens to about 100 bp), growth falls back to base for the own-currency inflation targeters (US, UK, Canada, Australia: real +1.5 offset by inflation near 1.5) and stays base +1 for the euro members, Denmark and China, whose bases carry little inflation to lose; the budget is the best case: the primary balance glides from today's level to a surplus of at least 1% of GDP by 2030 (1.5 pt better for Italy and Denmark, already in surplus) and holds it, the revenue harvest that did not materialise after 2001 but is assumed here; tier 1 moves to the tight spread and longer WAM. Who wins depends on maturity structure: short-WAM issuers roll into the cuts quickly, long-WAM issuers lock in phase-1 rates for decades (see the direction-of-travel page). **Base:** base growth, deficit held, market forwards, tier 1 at its middle pace. **Bear, inflation persists and rates stay higher for longer:** real −1.5 and inflation +1, so nominal growth 0.5 pt below base; no cuts (front end 25 bp over market) and the term premium rebuilds in proportion to the fiscal position (30-year +110 bp for the high-debt countries, +65 bp for the low-debt ones, France +50 and Italy +75 bp of spread loaded at ten years and beyond); the deficit worsens 1.5 pt; tier 1 at its fastest pace with the shorter WAM and stressed spread. **Repression, inflation of 3–4% with the curve engineered down:** inflation +1 with real growth at base, so nominal growth 1 pt above base; the full cut c is held for the decade (a negative real policy rate) and the long end is capped with the term premium near zero, so the curve is flat (ten-year about 1.3 pt over the one-year, thirty-year 0.3 pt over that); the deficit is held, because repression substitutes for consolidation and is never paired with an improving budget; tier 1 at its middle pace, terming out at the capped rates with spreads compressed to the tight setting as captive banks absorb provinces, states and Länder.

Two caveats on repression. For Germany, France and Italy it is an ECB-bloc case, not a national choice: it is shown hatched or as a hollow diamond, and presenting it next to the US and UK rows without that flag would overstate their options; it is nonetheless Italy's best cell in the whole model, which says something about what the euro's survival requires. Australia gets a shallower cap because offshore ownership leaks into the exchange rate. And someone pays: a ten-year yield of about 5.9% in the United States against inflation of 3.5–4% is a negative real return to bondholders for a decade. The interest bill is held flat by transferring the adjustment to savers.

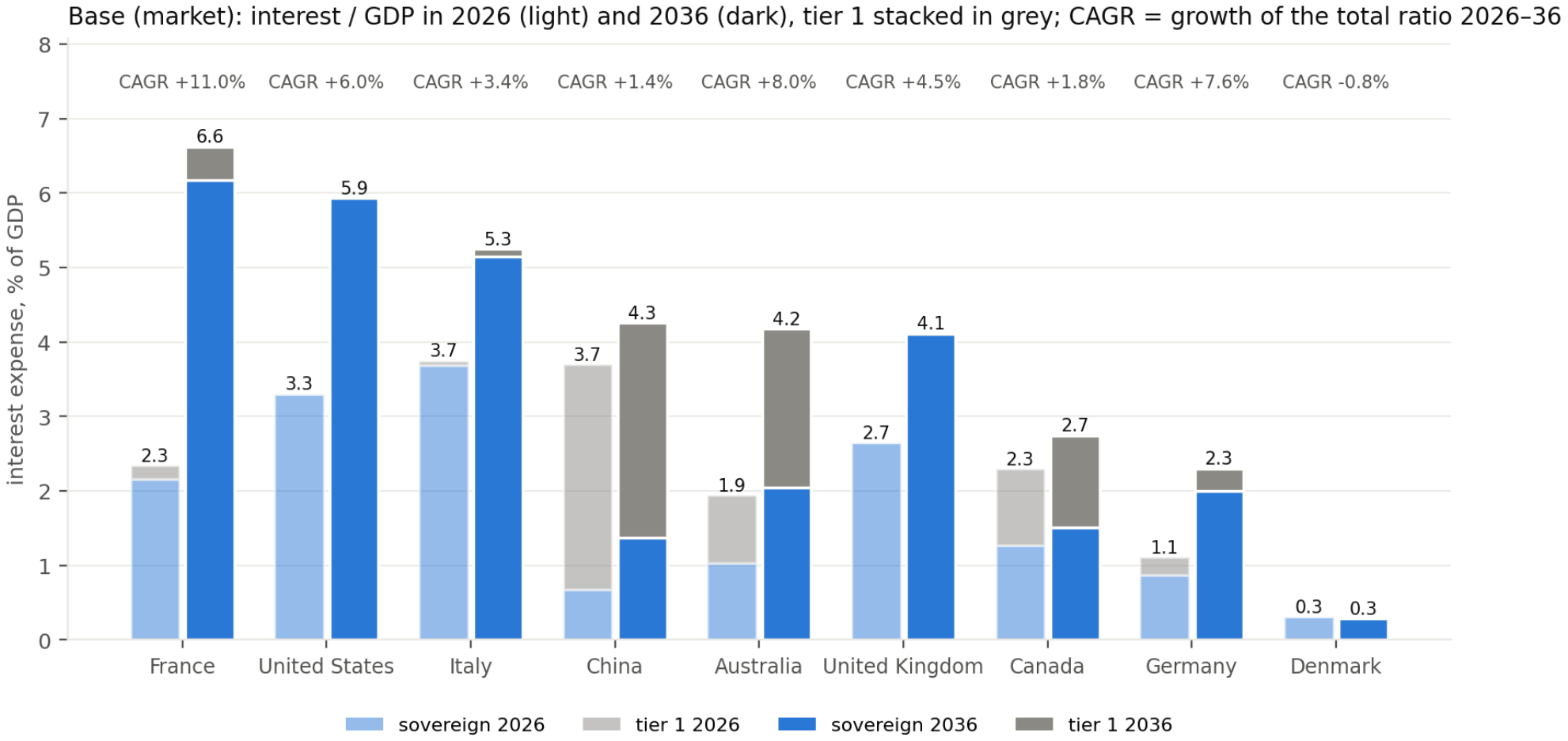
China is handled on its own terms: growth 6 / 5 / 4 / 5% (bull / base / bear / repression); bull and repression are the yield cap holding (market forwards, China already runs the repression curve), base is a developed-market steepening (long end +0.75 to +1 pt) and bear is the cap failing, a parallel +1.5 pt shift of the whole curve reached by year two. China's tier 1 includes LGFV bank and trust loans (~RMB 42tn, 29% of GDP) which no securities screen captures; every other country is bonds only. Where tier 1 exists the sovereign runs on a central-only deficit so sub-national borrowing is not counted twice.

In each bar chart a pair of bars is one country: the light bar is 2026, the dark bar 2036; the coloured segment is the sovereign and the grey segment the fiscal tier-1 blocks. The CAGR above each pair is the compound growth of the total interest/GDP ratio from 2026 to 2036.

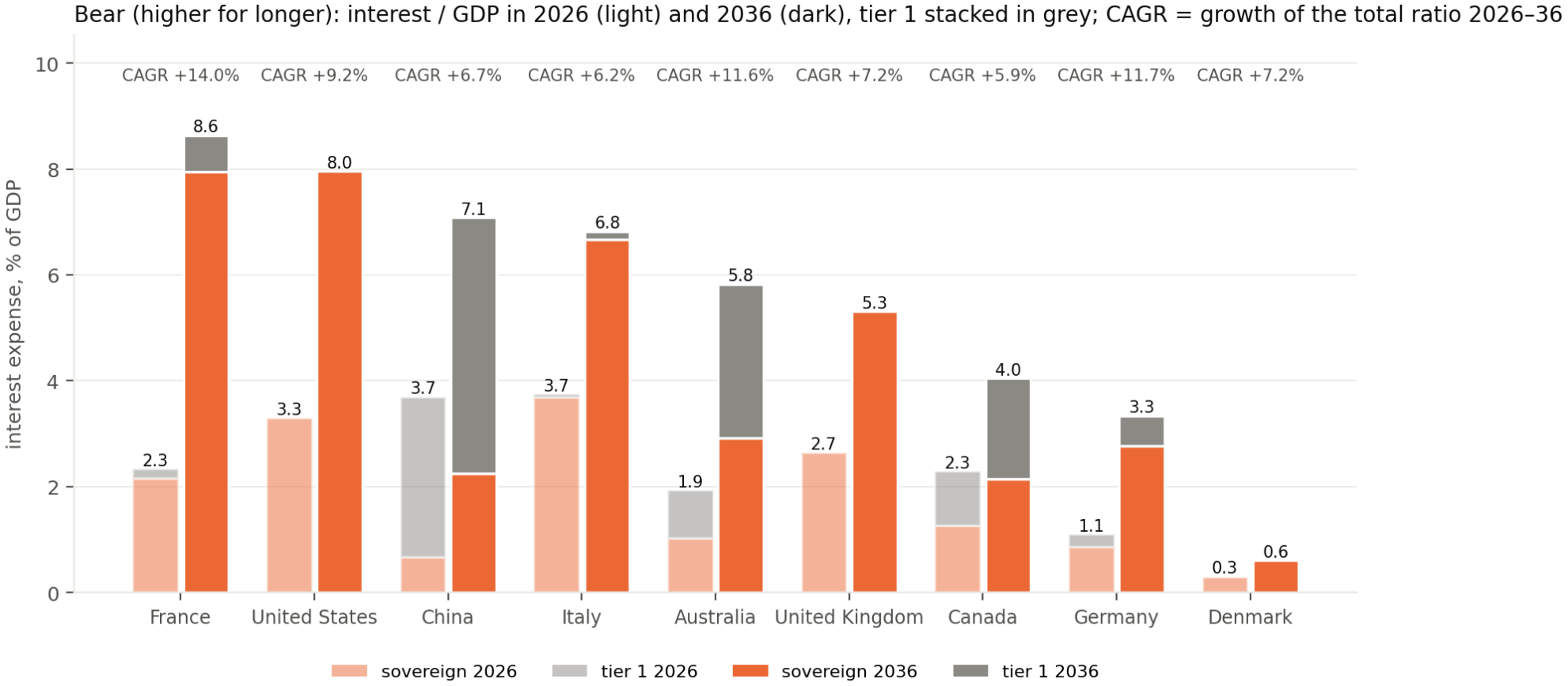
Bull case: interest / GDP in 2026 and 2036



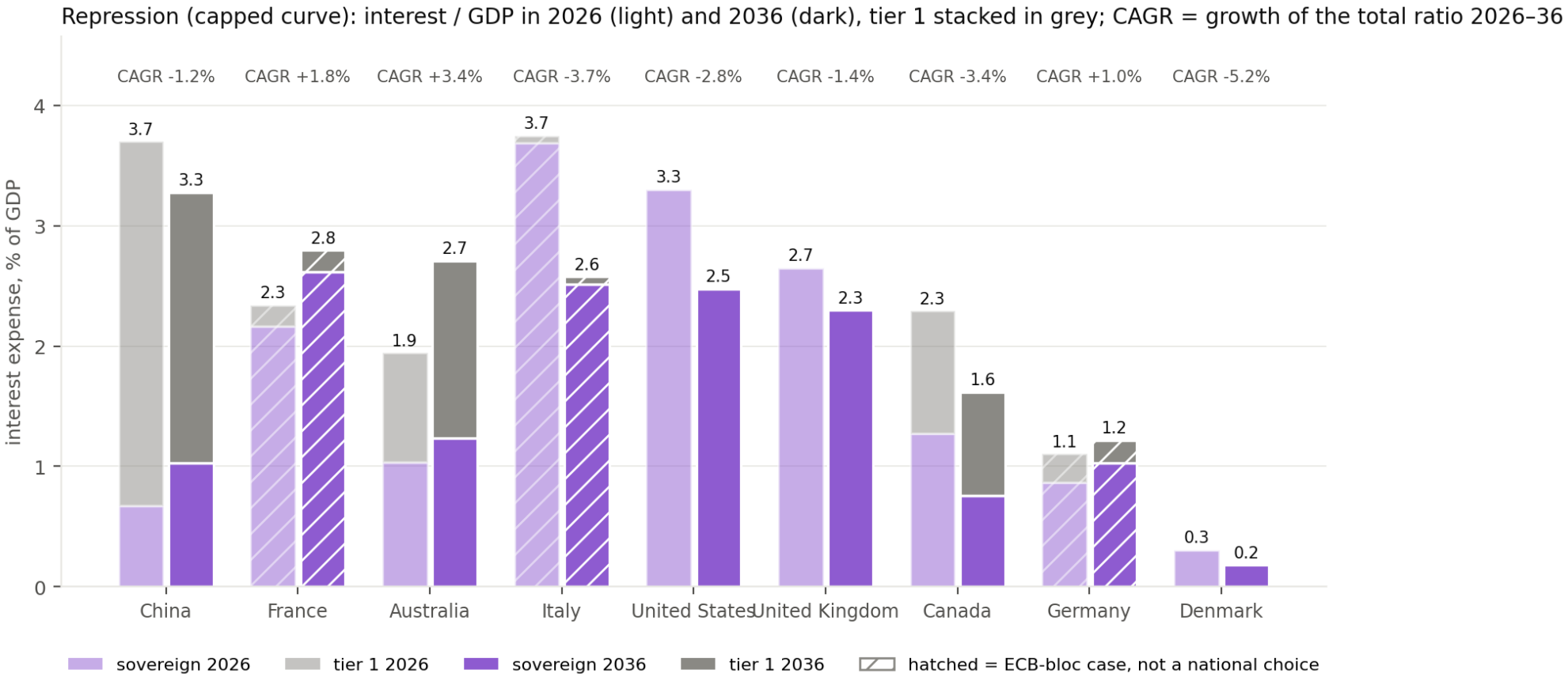
Base case: interest / GDP in 2026 and 2036



Bear case: interest / GDP in 2026 and 2036

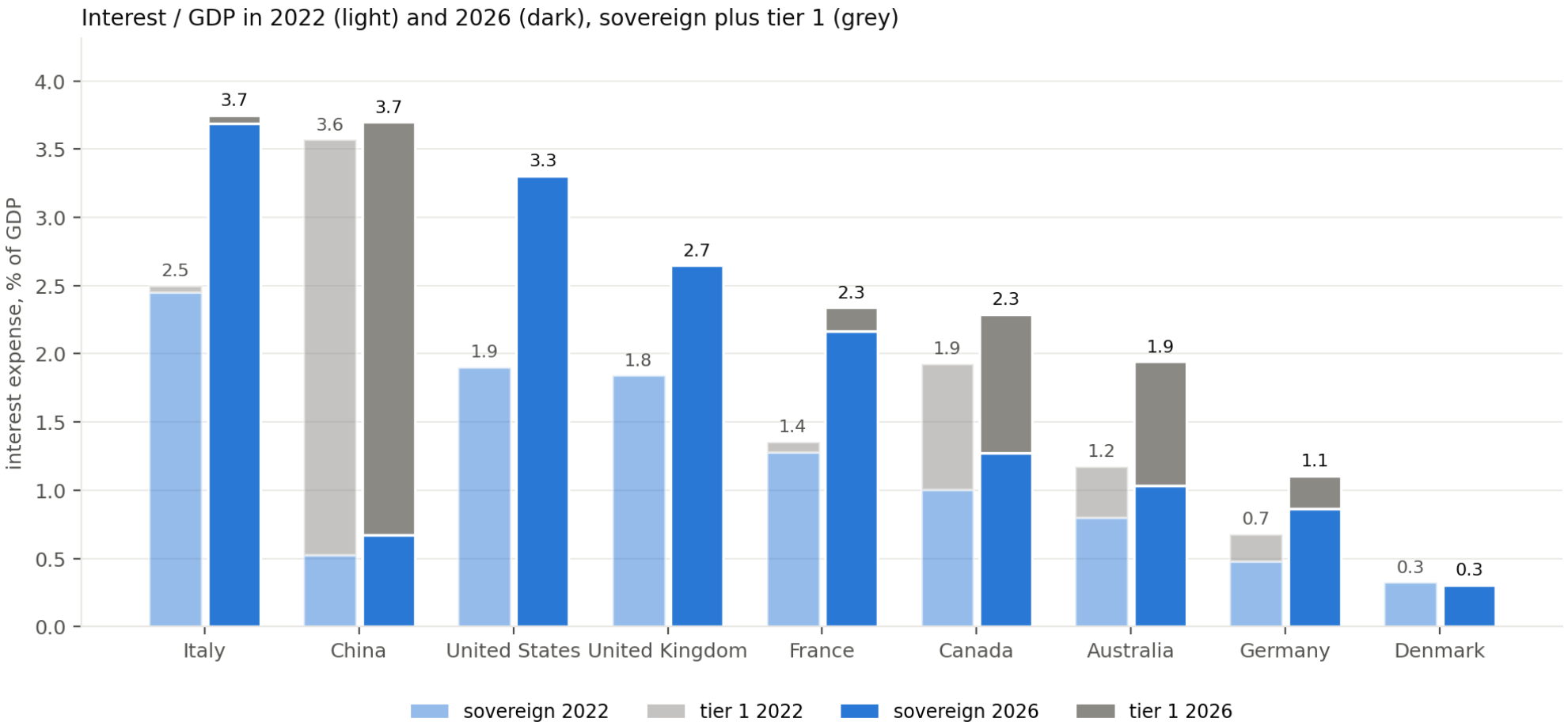


Repression case: interest / GDP in 2026 and 2036



Where the interest burden stands today: 2022 against 2026

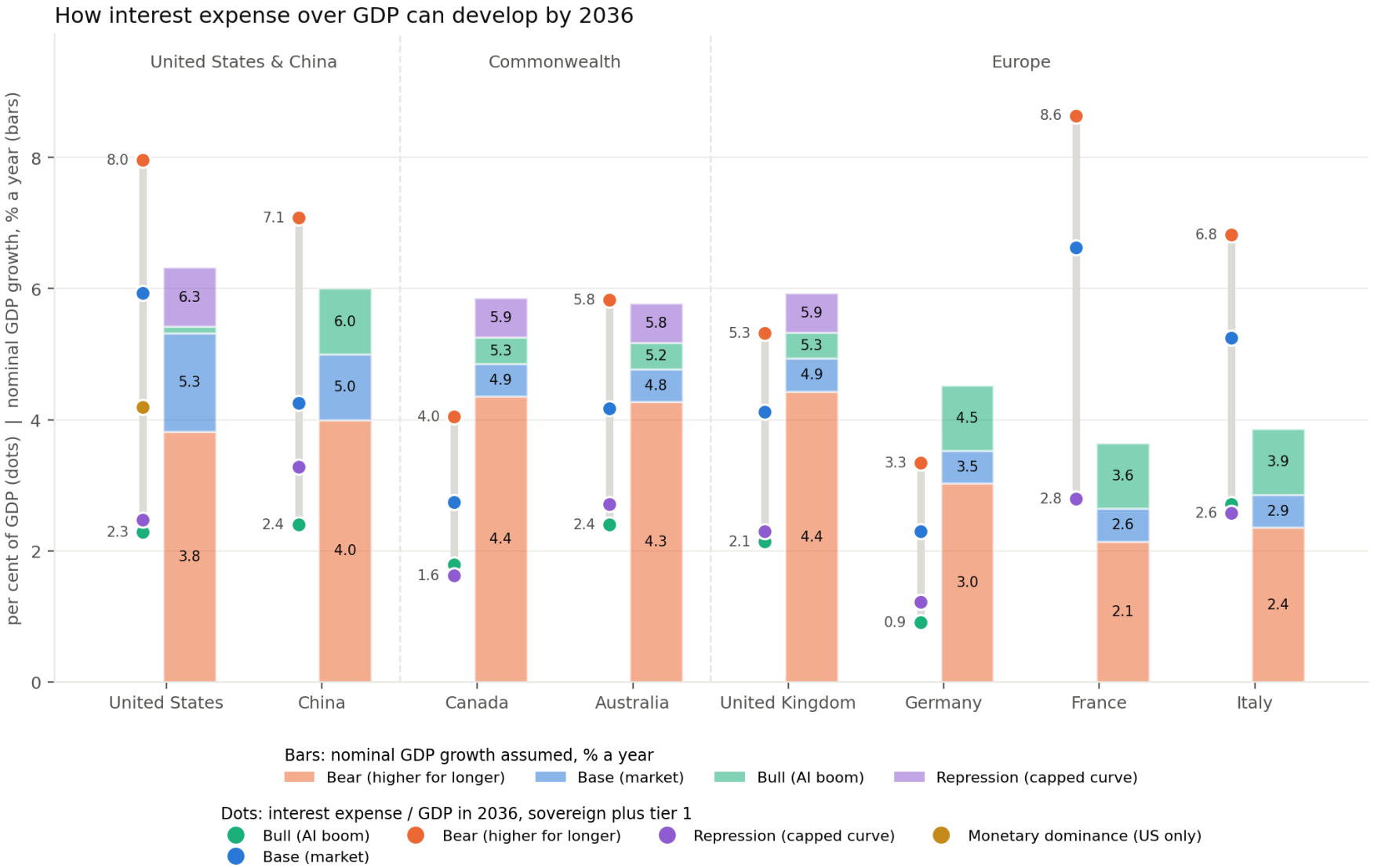
Bars: interest expense as a share of GDP in 2022 (light) and 2026 (dark); the coloured segment is the sovereign, the grey segment the fiscal tier-1 blocks (provinces, states, local government, Länder, French and Italian agencies). 2026 is the model's starting point, identical to the base-case bars elsewhere in this deck. Countries are ordered by the 2026 total.



2022 is rebuilt on the model's definitions from published figures: each sovereign's end-2022 marketable stock and average coupon or cash cost (US Treasury, Finance Canada, DMO/ONS, AFT and Cour des comptes, MEF, Finanzagentur, Danmarks Nationalbank, AOFM, Chinese MoF), the tier-1 blocks' 2022 stocks from the project's tier-1 files at 2022 effective rates (published for Ontario, NSW, CADES and Unédic; estimated for the rest), and World Bank 2022 nominal GDP. The UK rate is coupon interest net of the RPI uplift on index-linked gilts. Full sources per country are in INTEREST_THEN_VS_NOW.csv.

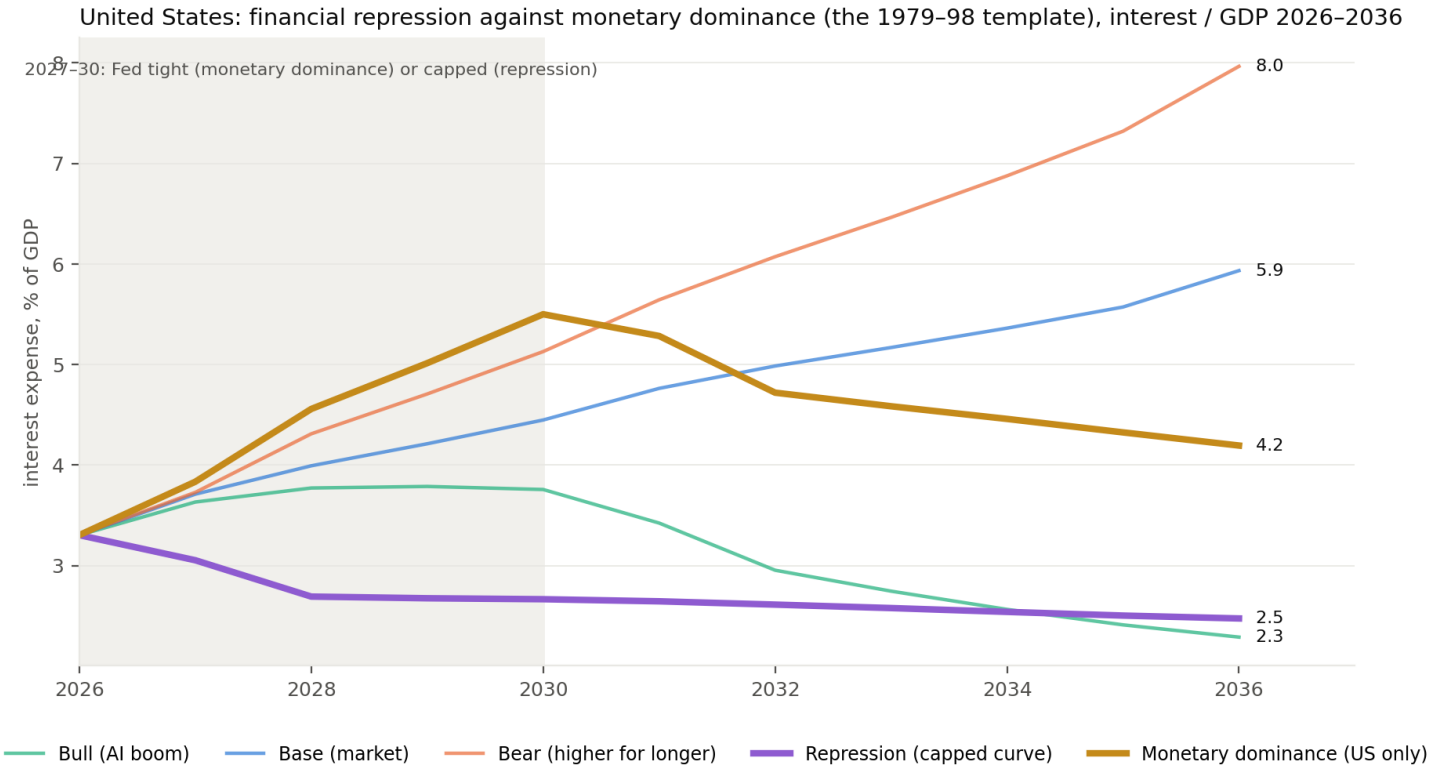
How interest expense over GDP can develop by 2036

For each country the dots are interest expense as a share of GDP in 2036 under the four cases, sovereign plus tier 1 (green = bull, blue = base, orange = bear, violet = repression; for France, Italy and Germany the repression case is an ECB-bloc decision rather than a national choice). The stacked bar beside them shows the nominal GDP growth assumed in each case, % a year, built up from the lowest case: each segment is the extra growth that case adds over the one below it, so the top of each segment is that case's growth rate (the bull is its 2027–36 average). Growth and interest share the same percentage axis. Countries are grouped by region; Denmark is left out of this chart because its bill is near zero in every case.



United States: financial repression against monetary dominance

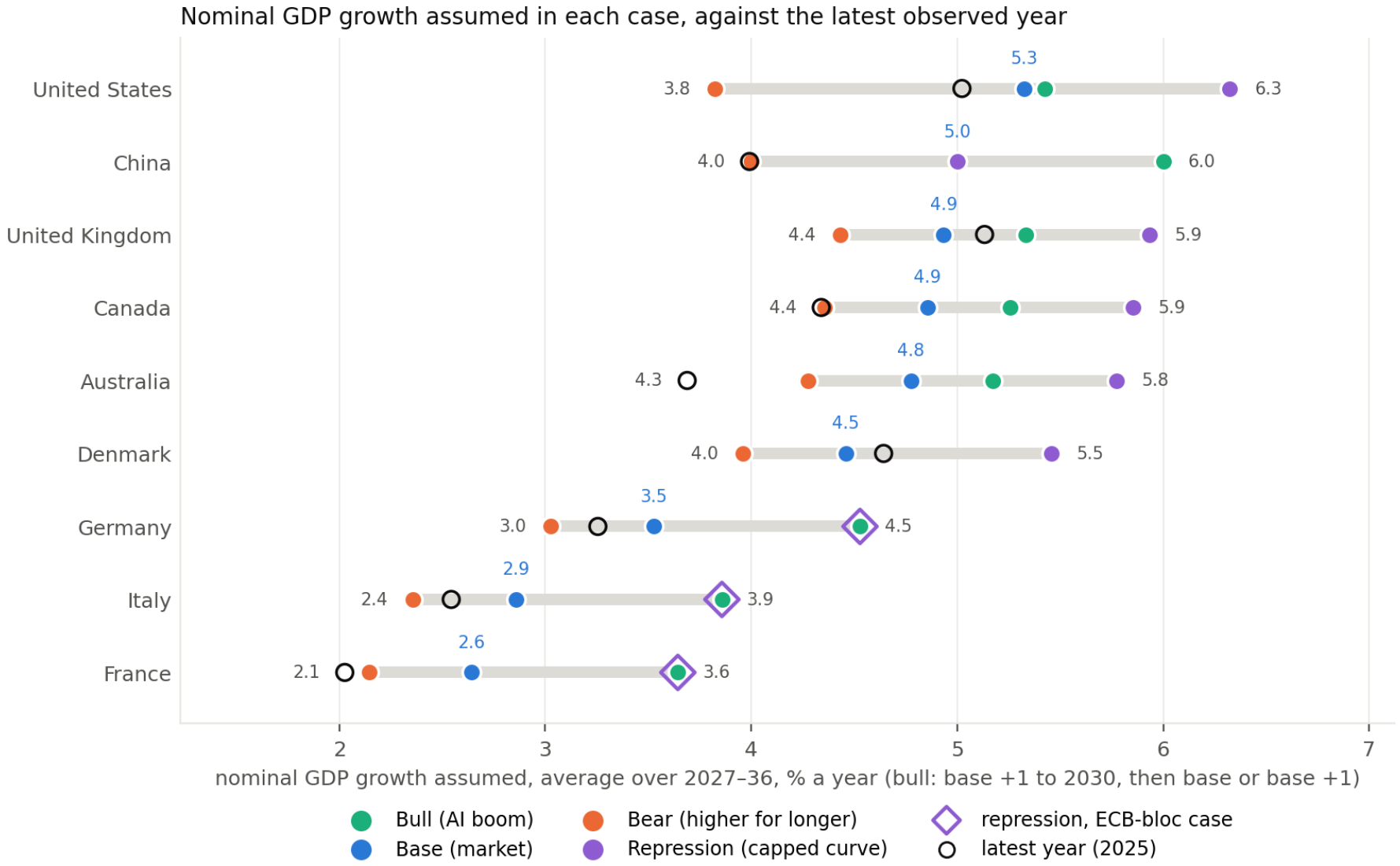
Two ways out of the same arithmetic. **Repression** caps the front end below inflation for the decade (1-year 1.9%, 2-year 2.2% from 2028) while the long end sits at the bear's levels because the Fed cannot hold it, runs inflation a point higher, takes the primary balance to zero by 2030 and shifts issuance to bills. **Monetary dominance** is the Volcker template: the Fed holds policy restrictive with a flat curve (1-year 5.6%, 10-year 5.6%, 30-year 5.9% from 2028) until inflation is beaten by 2030, a disinflation recession widens the deficit by 1.5 pt of GDP first, then credibility lets yields fall to a terminal curve by 2032 (2.5 / 2.7 / 3.5 / 3.9) and the budget is reversed to a 1% surplus by 2036. The 1980s version worked from a debt ratio half today's; on twice the stock the same four restrictive years cost far more interest before the relief arrives.



United States	2026	2030	2036	Peak	Avg cost 2030 → 2036	Debt / GDP 2036	Growth 2027–36 (real + infl.)	Primary balance 2030 → 2036
Bull (AI boom)	3.30%	3.76%	2.29%	3.79% (2029)	4.33 → 3.03	76%	6.3 (3.3 + 3.0) → 4.8 (3.3 + 1.5)	-1.0 → -1.0
Base (market)	3.30%	4.45%	5.93%	5.93% (2036)	4.36 → 4.71	131%	5.3 (2.3 + 3.0)	+5.2 → +5.2
Bear (higher for longer)	3.30%	5.13%	7.97%	7.97% (2036)	4.71 → 5.23	159%	3.8 (0.8 + 3.0)	+5.8 → +6.7
Repression (capped curve)	3.30%	2.67%	2.47%	3.30% (2026)	3.07 → 3.42	74%	6.3 (2.3 + 4.0)	+0.0 → +0.0
Monetary dominance (US only)	3.30%	5.50%	4.19%	5.50% (2030)	4.95 → 3.39	125%	3.8 (1.3 + 2.5) → 4.5 (3.0 + 1.5)	+6.7 → -1.0

Nominal growth assumptions, by country

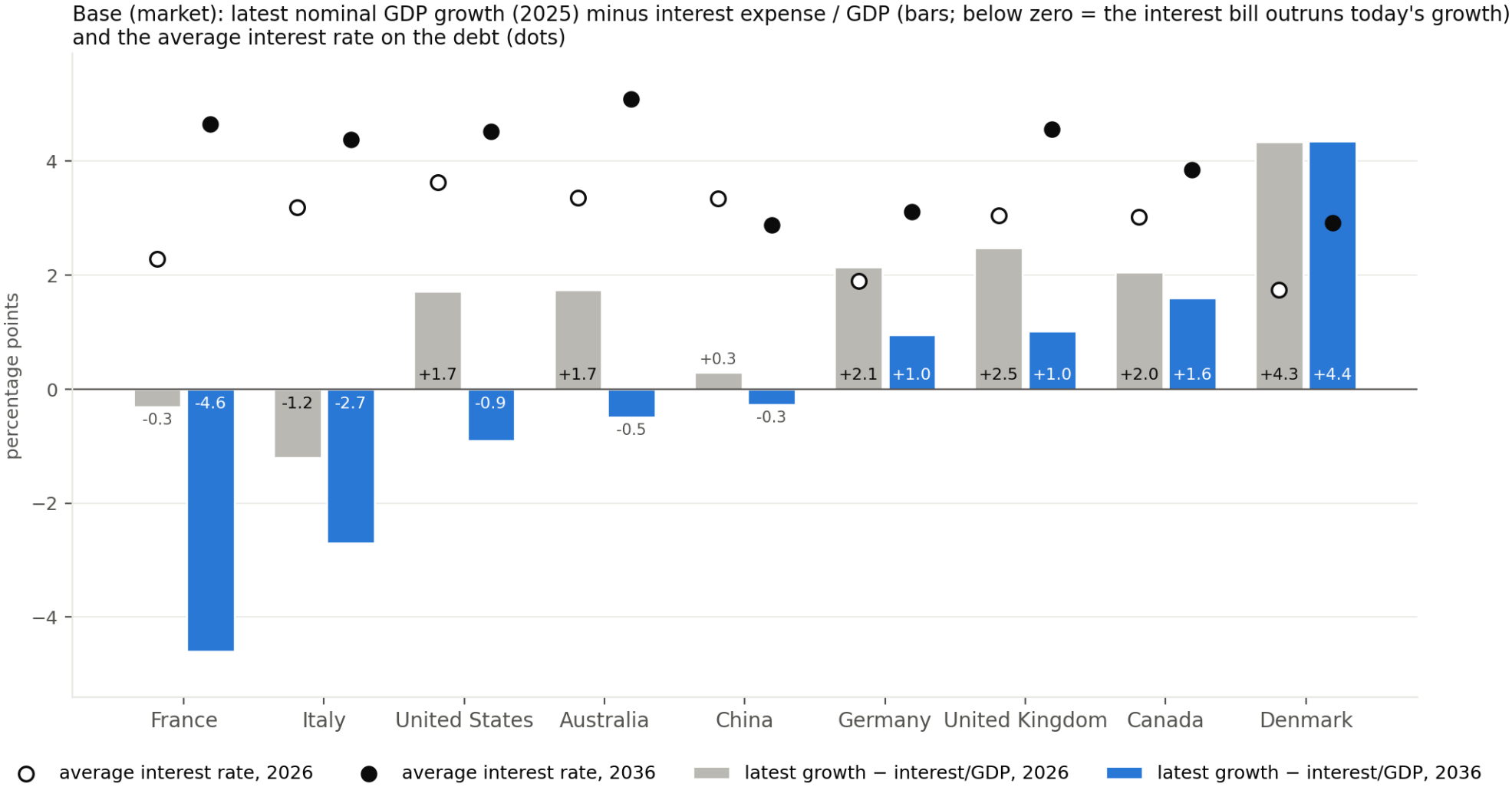
Base = average of the 2016–25 CAGR and the latest year; bull = base + 0.5; bear = base – 0.5; repression = base + 1.0 (inflation, not real growth). China 6 / 5 / 4 / 5. The hollow circle is the latest observed year (2025). Countries are ordered by the base assumption.

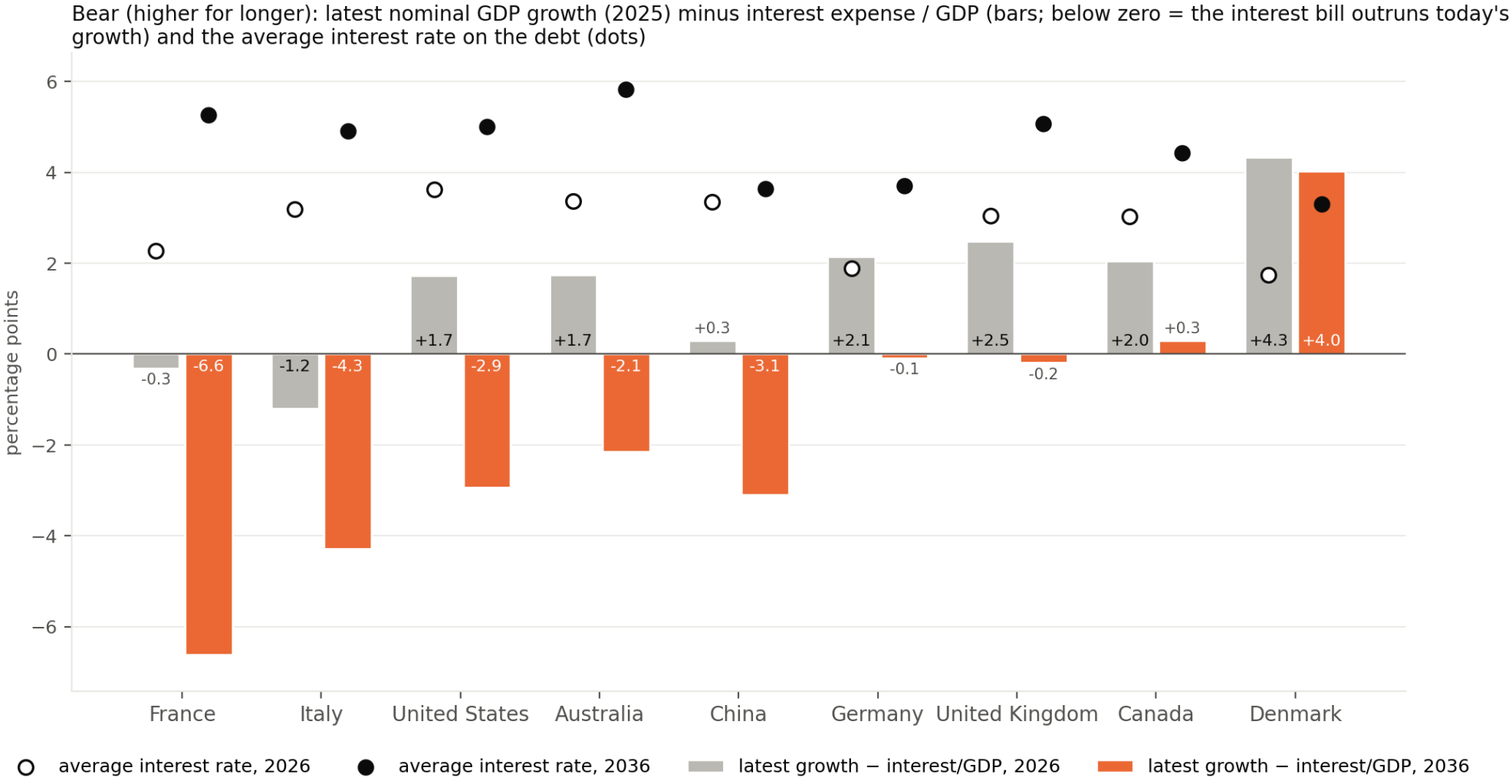


Nominal growth against interest / GDP

Bars: the latest observed nominal GDP growth rate (2025, the same number in every case and year) minus interest expense as a share of GDP (sovereign plus fiscal tier 1), in percentage points, so a bar below zero means the interest bill exceeds today's growth rate. Grey is 2026, coloured is the case's 2036 interest/GDP. Dots: the outright average interest rate paid on the debt stock, hollow for 2026 and filled for 2036. One chart per case follows.


Bull (AI boom): latest nominal GDP growth (2025) minus interest expense / GDP (bars; below zero = the interest bill outruns today's growth) and the average interest rate on the debt (dots)
percentage points
5
4
3
2
1
0
−1
−2
-0.3
-0.8
-1.2
-0.2
+1.7
+2.7
+1.7
+1.3
+0.3
+1.6
+2.1
+2.3
+2.5
+3.0
+2.0
+2.6
+4.3
+4.6
France
Italy
United States
Australia
China
Germany
United Kingdom
Canada
Denmark
average interest rate, 2026
average interest rate, 2036
latest growth − interest/GDP, 2026
latest growth − interest/GDP, 2036

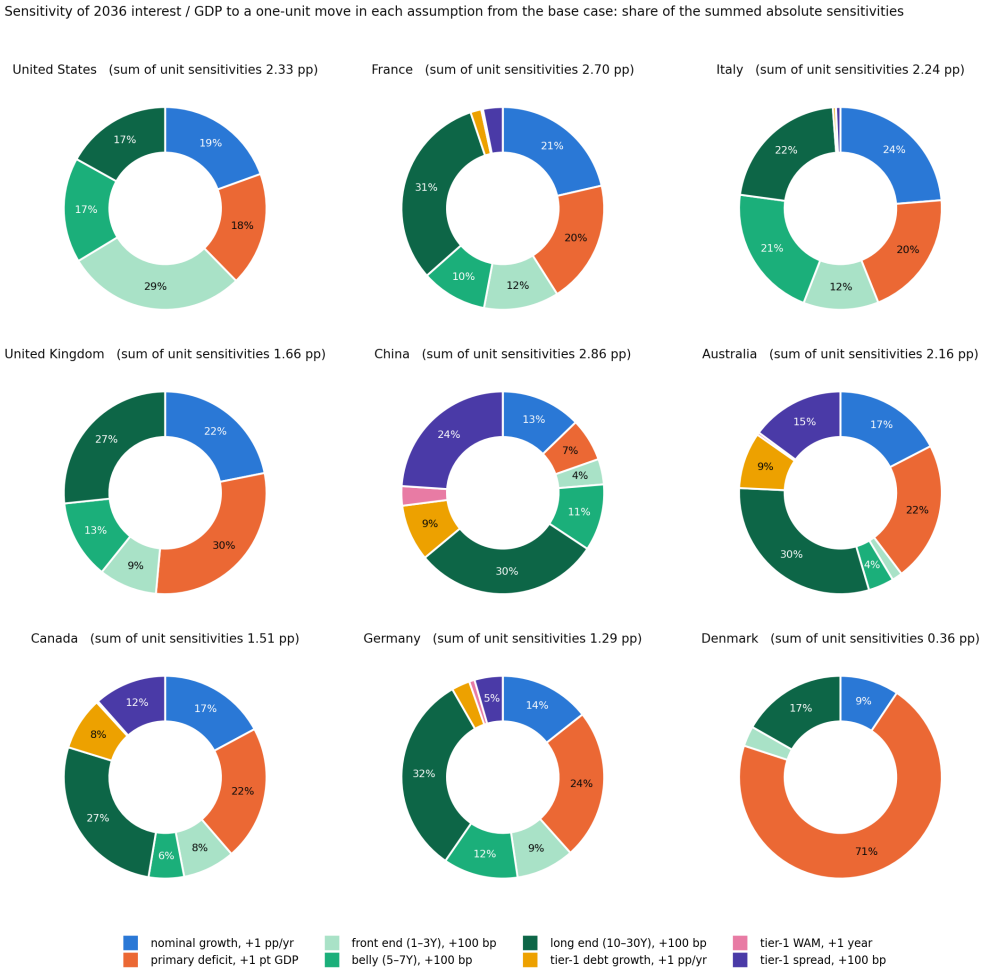

Base (market): latest nominal GDP growth (2025) minus interest expense / GDP (bars; below zero = the interest bill outruns today's growth) and the average interest rate on the debt (dots)
percentage points
4
2
0
−2
−4
-0.3
-4.6
-1.2
-2.7
+1.7
-0.9
+1.7
-0.5
+0.3
-0.3
+2.1
+1.0
+2.5
+1.0
+2.0
+1.6
+4.3
+4.4
France
Italy
United States
Australia
China
Germany
United Kingdom
Canada
Denmark
average interest rate, 2026
average interest rate, 2036
latest growth − interest/GDP, 2026
latest growth − interest/GDP, 2036


Bear (higher for longer): latest nominal GDP growth (2025) minus interest expense / GDP (bars; below zero = the interest bill outruns today's growth) and the average interest rate on the debt (dots)
percentage points
6
4
2
0
−2
−4
−6
-0.3
-6.6
-1.2
-4.3
+1.7
-2.9
+1.7
-2.1
+0.3
-3.1
+2.1
-0.1
+2.5
-0.2
+2.0
+0.3
+4.3
+4.0
France
Italy
United States
Australia
China
Germany
United Kingdom
Canada
Denmark
average interest rate, 2026
average interest rate, 2036
latest growth − interest/GDP, 2026
latest growth − interest/GDP, 2036


Repression (capped curve): latest nominal GDP growth (2025) minus interest expense / GDP (bars; below zero = the interest bill outruns today's growth) and the average interest rate on the debt (dots); hatched = ECB-bloc case
percentage points
5
4
3
2
1
0
−1
−2
-0.3
-0.8
-1.2
-0.0
+1.7
+2.5
+1.7
+1.0
+0.3
+0.7
+2.1
+2.0
+2.5
+2.8
+2.0
+2.7
+4.3
+4.5
France
Italy
United States
Australia
China
Germany
United Kingdom
Canada
Denmark
average interest rate, 2026
average interest rate, 2036
latest growth − interest/GDP, 2026
latest growth − interest/GDP, 2036

Which assumptions the ratio is most sensitive to

A like-for-like sensitivity rather than a decomposition of the scenarios: each assumption is moved by one unit from the base case with everything else at base, and the change in 2036 interest/GDP (sovereign plus tier 1) is recorded as the average of the up and down moves. The units are the conventional ones: +1 pp a year of nominal growth, +1 pt of GDP of primary deficit held every year, +100 bp on one segment of the curve at a time from 2027 (front end = the 1- to 3-year, belly = 5- and 7-year, long end = 10- to 30-year, each built from bumps at the tenors the sovereign issues at that fade linearly to the neighbouring tenors, so tier-1 paper priced at odd maturities moves too; the three segments add up to a parallel shift), +1 pp a year of tier-1 stock growth, +1 year of tier-1 WAM, +100 bp of tier-1 spread. Each slice is that lever's share of the summed absolute sensitivities, so the picture does not depend on how large the bull and bear settings happen to be. The table on the next page gives the sensitivities in points of GDP per unit, tenor by tenor, which is what to compare across countries. A segment's slice is the product of how much the country issues there and how long that paper then sits on the books at the new rate.



Sensitivities in points of GDP of 2036 interest / GDP per unit move (base case)

Country	Base 2036	Growth +1pp	Deficit +1pt	1Y +100bp	2Y +100bp	3Y +100bp	5Y +100bp	7Y +100bp	10Y +100bp	20Y +100bp	30Y +100bp	T1 growth +1pt	T1 WAM +1y	T1 spread +100bp	Curve parallel +100bp
France	6.63%	-0.58	+0.53	+0.23	+0.00	+0.09	+0.21	+0.07	+0.46	+0.30	+0.08	+0.05	-0.01	+0.08	+1.45
United States	5.93%	-0.45	+0.42	+0.44	+0.10	+0.13	+0.21	+0.18	+0.21	+0.07	+0.12	—	—	—	+1.45
Italy	5.25%	-0.53	+0.45	+0.17	+0.04	+0.06	+0.15	+0.32	+0.30	+0.14	+0.04	+0.01	-0.00	+0.02	+1.23
China	4.26%	-0.37	+0.20	+0.01	+0.04	+0.07	+0.16	+0.14	+0.17	+0.57	+0.10	+0.26	+0.09	+0.68	+1.27
Australia	4.18%	-0.38	+0.48	+0.04	+0.00	+0.00	+0.05	+0.04	+0.47	+0.15	+0.04	+0.19	+0.01	+0.32	+0.78
United Kingdom	4.11%	-0.36	+0.49	+0.07	+0.00	+0.08	+0.13	+0.07	+0.32	+0.08	+0.04	—	—	—	+0.80
Canada	2.74%	-0.26	+0.32	+0.07	+0.05	+0.00	+0.09	+0.00	+0.17	+0.14	+0.10	+0.13	-0.00	+0.17	+0.62
Germany	2.30%	-0.19	+0.31	+0.05	+0.07	+0.00	+0.12	+0.04	+0.27	+0.08	+0.06	+0.04	-0.01	+0.06	+0.69
Denmark	0.28%	-0.03	+0.26	+0.00	+0.01	+0.00	+0.00	+0.00	+0.06	+0.00	+0.00	—	—	—	+0.07

Negative = the ratio falls when the assumption rises (growth). The eight tenor columns add up to the parallel-shift column (small differences are the engine's non-linearity). A tenor's sensitivity is the share of issuance at that tenor times the years that paper then carries the higher coupon within the horizon: bills reprice every year, so a 100 bp move in the 1-year rate hits two-thirds of US issuance for a full decade, while a 30-year bump only touches the few per cent issued there. Growth matters most where the interest bill is already large (Italy), tier-1 growth and spread where the sub-national stock is large (China, Australia, Canada). Tier-1 WAM barely registers because lengthening the book changes when repricing happens, not whether.

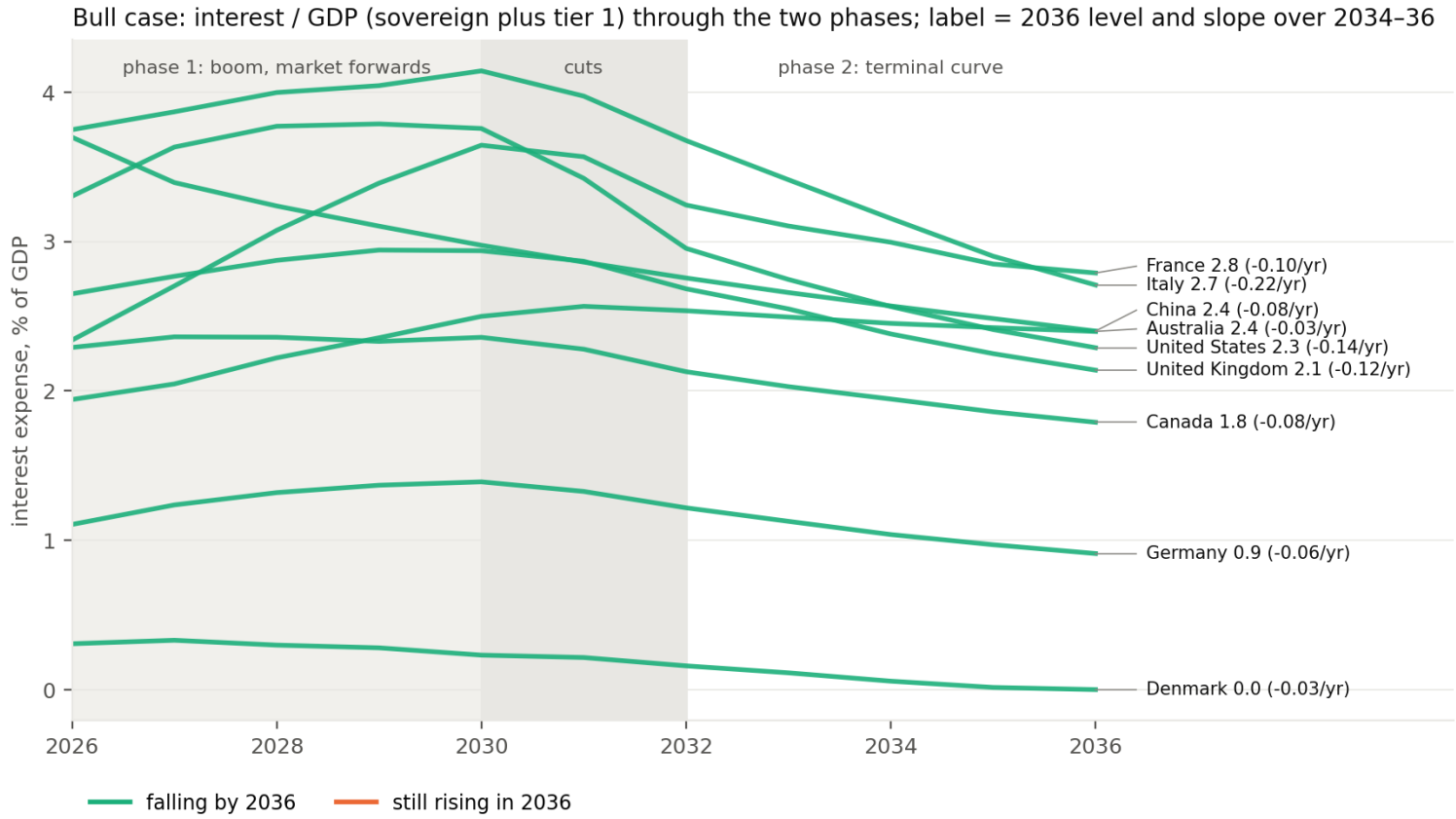
Interest / GDP in 2026 and 2036 and its 2026–36 CAGR, by case (total including tier 1)

Country	Bull 2026	Bull 2036	Bull CAGR	Base 2026	Base 2036	Base CAGR	Bear 2026	Bear 2036	Bear CAGR	Repression 2026	Repression 2036	Repression CAGR
France	2.34%	2.79%	+1.8%	2.34%	6.63%	+11.0%	2.34%	8.64%	+14.0%	2.34%	2.80%	+1.8%
United States	3.30%	2.29%	-3.6%	3.30%	5.93%	+6.0%	3.30%	7.97%	+9.2%	3.30%	2.47%	-2.8%
Italy	3.75%	2.71%	-3.2%	3.75%	5.25%	+3.4%	3.75%	6.83%	+6.2%	3.75%	2.58%	-3.7%
China	3.70%	2.40%	-4.2%	3.70%	4.26%	+1.4%	3.70%	7.08%	+6.7%	3.70%	3.28%	-1.2%
Australia	1.94%	2.40%	+2.1%	1.94%	4.18%	+8.0%	1.94%	5.83%	+11.6%	1.94%	2.71%	+3.4%
United Kingdom	2.65%	2.14%	-2.1%	2.65%	4.11%	+4.5%	2.65%	5.32%	+7.2%	2.65%	2.30%	-1.4%
Canada	2.29%	1.79%	-2.4%	2.29%	2.74%	+1.8%	2.29%	4.05%	+5.9%	2.29%	1.62%	-3.4%
Germany	1.11%	0.91%	-1.9%	1.11%	2.30%	+7.6%	1.11%	3.34%	+11.7%	1.11%	1.22%	+1.0%
Denmark	0.31%	0.00%	+nan%	0.31%	0.28%	-0.8%	0.31%	0.62%	+7.2%	0.31%	0.18%	-5.2%

Repression for Germany, France and Italy is an ECB-bloc case (see the first page).

Bull case: 2036 level and direction of travel

The two-phase bull rewards issuers that roll their stock quickly after the 2031–32 cuts and does little for those that locked in phase-1 rates. The chart shows the bull path of total interest/GDP for each country; the table gives the level at the end of each phase, the slope over the last two years (negative = the ratio is falling by 2036), the sovereign's average cost at the end of phase 1 and in 2036, and the share of today's stock that reprices within three years, which is what sets the speed.



Country	2026	2030 (end phase 1)	2032	2036	Slope 2034→36 (pp/yr)	Avg cost 2030 → 2036	Reprices within 3y	Base 2036
Italy	3.75%	4.14%	3.68%	2.71%	-0.22	3.85 → 2.94	35%	5.25%
United States	3.30%	3.76%	2.95%	2.29%	-0.14	4.33 → 3.03	57%	5.93%
United Kingdom	2.65%	2.94%	2.68%	2.14%	-0.12	3.81 → 3.26	24%	4.11%
France	2.34%	3.65%	3.24%	2.79%	-0.10	3.66 → 3.09	34%	6.63%
China	3.70%	2.98%	2.76%	2.40%	-0.08	1.93 → 2.02	39%	4.26%
Canada	2.29%	2.36%	2.13%	1.79%	-0.08	3.32 → 2.75	45%	2.74%
Germany	1.11%	1.39%	1.22%	0.91%	-0.06	2.68 → 2.22	37%	2.30%

Country	2026	2030 (end phase 1)	2032	2036	Slope 2034→36 (pp/yr)	Avg cost 2030 → 2036	Reprices within 3y	Base 2036
Denmark	0.31%	0.23%	0.16%	0.00%	-0.03	2.16 → 2.73	30%	0.28%
Australia	1.94%	2.50%	2.54%	2.40%	-0.03	3.98 → 3.76	32%	4.18%

Assumptions behind each case

One page per case. Growth is nominal GDP growth, % a year, with its split into real growth and inflation in brackets (an arrow marks a change over the horizon). Base real growth is the average of the 2016–25 real GDP CAGR and 2025 (World Bank, constant prices); base inflation is nominal less real, i.e. the GDP deflator. The bull adds +1 real with inflation unchanged in the boom, then +1.5 real against –1.5 inflation (US, UK, Canada, Australia) or –0.5 (euro members, Denmark); the bear is –1.5 real and +1 inflation; repression is +1 inflation with real growth at base. Primary balance is % of GDP with + = deficit, shown at 2027, 2030 and 2036; where a country has tier 1 the sovereign runs on the central balance (general government less the sub-national sector's own balance) so sub-national borrowing is counted once. The curve is the new-issue rate at 1, 10 and 30 years in 2028 and in 2036; every other tenor moves with the nearest set points. Tier 1 is summarised across the fiscal blocks: stock as % of GDP, stock growth in the first year, debt-weighted WAM and spread over the sovereign curve (an arrow marks a change over the horizon). * = ECB-bloc case, not a national choice.

Bull: AI boom, then disinflation

AI boom, then disinflation, in two phases. 2027–30: a capex boom financed on market forwards, nominal growth 1 pt above base with inflation still 3–4%, and a revenue harvest that takes the primary balance to a surplus of at least 1% of GDP by 2030 (1.5 pt better where already in surplus). From 2031 the buildout is done, inflation falls and central banks cut: the curve glides over 2031–32 to a low terminal level and holds; growth falls back to base for the US, UK, Canada and Australia and stays base +1 for the euro members, Denmark and China; the surplus is held. Tier 1 keeps its middle growth pace and moves to the longer WAM and tight spread as the cuts arrive. China's curve stays at market (the cap holds). United States: the boom phase is the same (real +1.0, inflation unchanged), but from 2031 real growth +1.0 is outweighed by inflation –1.5, so nominal growth runs 0.5 pt below base; the surplus and the curve path are as above.

Country	Growth, %/yr nominal (real + inflation)	Primary balance, % GDP 2027 / 2030 / 2036	Curve 2028 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Curve 2036 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Tier 1 (fiscal blocks)
United States	6.3 (3.3 + 3.0) → 4.8 (3.3 + 1.5)	+3.6 / -1.0 / -1.0	4.6 / 5.1 / 5.4	2.0 / 3.0 / 3.5	—
France	3.6 (2.0 + 1.6)	+1.7 / -1.0 / -1.0	3.9 / 5.1 / 5.5	1.2 / 2.8 / 3.2	CADES, Unédic, ACOSS, 8% of GDP: growth +3.2%/yr; WAM 4 → 5y; spread +20 → 10 bp
Italy	3.9 (1.8 + 2.1)	-1.3 / -2.4 / -2.4	4.0 / 4.7 / 5.2	1.2 / 2.9 / 3.3	CDP, FS, 2% of GDP: growth +4.0%/yr; WAM 5 → 7y; spread +30 → 20 bp
United Kingdom	5.9 (2.3 + 3.6) → 4.9 (2.8 + 2.1)	+0.7 / -1.0 / -1.0	4.7 / 5.4 / 5.8	1.8 / 2.9 / 3.4	—
China	6.0 (6.2 – 0.2)	+2.8 / -1.0 / -1.0	1.2 / 1.7 / 2.1	1.5 / 1.8 / 2.1	local govt + LGFV, 80% of GDP: growth LGB +16%, LGFV -3%; WAM 6 → 8y; spread +88 → 52 bp
Australia	5.8 (2.8 + 3.0) → 4.8 (3.3 + 1.5)	+0.5 / -1.0 / -1.0	4.6 / 5.2 / 5.7	1.8 / 2.9 / 3.4	states, 23% of GDP: growth +10.7%/yr; WAM 7 → 9y; spread +51 → 41 bp
Canada	5.9 (2.9 + 2.9) → 4.9 (3.4 + 1.4)	-0.1 / -1.3 / -1.3	3.2 / 3.9 / 4.2	1.5 / 2.5 / 2.9	provinces, 30% of GDP: growth +4.8%/yr; WAM 11 → 14y; spread +70 → 47 bp
Germany	4.5 (1.4 + 3.1)	+1.5 / -1.0 / -1.0	2.9 / 3.4 / 3.7	1.0 / 1.8 / 2.2	Länder, 14% of GDP: growth +0.2%/yr; WAM 6 → 8y; spread +36 → 26 bp
Denmark	5.5 (3.5 + 2.0)	-0.9 / -2.0 / -2.0	2.7 / 3.3 / 3.6	0.8 / 1.6 / 2.0	—

Base: market forwards

Market pricing. New issuance is priced at the forward rates implied by today's curve with today's term premium; nominal growth is the average of the 2016–25 CAGR and the latest year; the primary balance is held at today's level; tier 1 grows at its middle historical pace with its current WAM and through-cycle spread. China's administered curve steepens the way a developed market's would (long end +0.75 to +1 pt).

Country	Growth, %/yr nominal (real + inflation)	Primary balance, % GDP 2027 / 2030 / 2036	Curve 2028 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Curve 2036 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Tier 1 (fiscal blocks)
United States	5.3 (2.3 + 3.0)	+5.2 / +5.2 / +5.2	4.6 / 5.1 / 5.4	4.5 / 5.2 / 5.4	—
France	2.6 (1.0 + 1.6)	+2.6 / +2.6 / +2.6	3.9 / 5.1 / 5.5	4.7 / 5.2 / 5.5	CADES, Unédic, ACOSS, 8% of GDP: growth +3.2%/yr; WAM 4y; spread +20 bp
Italy	2.9 (0.8 + 2.1)	-0.9 / -0.9 / -0.9	4.0 / 4.7 / 5.2	4.3 / 4.8 / 5.2	CDP, FS, 2% of GDP: growth +4.0%/yr; WAM 5y; spread +30 bp
United Kingdom	4.9 (1.3 + 3.6)	+1.2 / +1.2 / +1.2	4.7 / 5.4 / 5.8	4.6 / 5.4 / 5.5	—
China	5.0 (5.2 – 0.2)	+4.1 / +4.1 / +4.1	1.2 / 2.4 / 3.1	1.5 / 2.6 / 3.1	local govt + LGFV, 80% of GDP: growth LGB +16%, LGFV -3%; WAM 6y; spread +88 bp
Australia	4.8 (1.8 + 3.0)	+0.9 / +0.9 / +0.9	4.6 / 5.2 / 5.7	4.6 / 5.2 / 5.7	states, 23% of GDP: growth +10.7%/yr; WAM 7y; spread +51 bp
Canada	4.9 (1.9 + 2.9)	+0.2 / +0.2 / +0.2	3.2 / 3.9 / 4.2	3.3 / 3.8 / 4.2	provinces, 30% of GDP: growth +4.8%/yr; WAM 11y; spread +70 bp
Germany	3.5 (0.4 + 3.1)	+2.4 / +2.4 / +2.4	2.9 / 3.4 / 3.7	3.1 / 3.5 / 3.8	Länder, 14% of GDP: growth +0.2%/yr; WAM 6y; spread +36 bp
Denmark	4.5 (2.5 + 2.0)	-0.5 / -0.5 / -0.5	2.7 / 3.3 / 3.6	2.6 / 3.1 / 3.7	—

Bear: inflation persists, higher for longer

Inflation persists and rates stay higher for longer. No cuts: the front end sits 25 bp over market and the term premium rebuilds in proportion to the fiscal position (30-year +110 bp for the high-debt countries, +65 bp for the low-debt ones, France +50 and Italy +75 bp of spread from ten years out), reached by 2028 and held as a spread over market forwards. Nominal growth 0.5 pt below base, the primary deficit 1.5 pt of GDP worse by 2036, tier 1 at its fastest historical pace with the shorter WAM and stressed spread. China: the yield cap fails, a parallel +1.5 pt shift. United States: real growth –1.5 with inflation unchanged, so nominal growth is 1.5 pt below base.

Country	Growth, %/yr nominal (real + inflation)	Primary balance, % GDP 2027 / 2030 / 2036	Curve 2028 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Curve 2036 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Tier 1 (fiscal blocks)
United States	3.8 (0.8 + 3.0)	+5.3 / +5.8 / +6.7	4.9 / 5.9 / 6.5	4.8 / 6.1 / 6.5	—
France	2.1 (-0.5 + 2.6)	+2.8 / +3.2 / +4.1	4.2 / 6.0 / 6.6	5.0 / 6.1 / 6.6	CADES, Unédic, ACOSS, 8% of GDP: growth +6.1%/yr; WAM 3y; spread +30 bp
Italy	2.4 (-0.7 + 3.1)	-0.7 / -0.3 / +0.6	4.3 / 5.5 / 6.3	4.7 / 5.6 / 6.3	CDP, FS, 2% of GDP: growth +7.1%/yr; WAM 4y; spread +40 bp
United Kingdom	4.4 (-0.2 + 4.6)	+1.4 / +1.8 / +2.7	5.0 / 6.2 / 6.9	4.9 / 6.2 / 6.6	—
China	4.0 (3.7 + 0.3)	+4.2 / +4.7 / +5.6	2.7 / 3.2 / 3.6	3.0 / 3.3 / 3.6	local govt + LGFV, 80% of GDP: growth LGB +16%, LGFV -3%; WAM 5y; spread +206 bp
Australia	4.3 (0.3 + 4.0)	+1.1 / +1.5 / +2.4	4.9 / 6.0 / 6.4	4.9 / 6.0 / 6.4	states, 23% of GDP: growth +11.9%/yr; WAM 5y; spread +90 bp
Canada	4.4 (0.4 + 3.9)	+0.4 / +0.8 / +1.7	3.5 / 4.7 / 4.9	3.6 / 4.6 / 4.9	provinces, 30% of GDP: growth +7.1%/yr; WAM 8y; spread +95 bp
Germany	3.0 (-1.1 + 4.1)	+2.5 / +3.0 / +3.9	3.2 / 4.2 / 4.4	3.4 / 4.2 / 4.4	Länder, 14% of GDP: growth +3.2%/yr; WAM 4y; spread +65 bp
Denmark	4.0 (1.0 + 3.0)	-0.4 / +0.1 / +1.0	3.0 / 4.0 / 4.3	2.9 / 3.9 / 4.3	—

Repression: inflation 3–4%, curve capped

Inflation of 3–4% with the curve engineered down. The full easing cycle is held for the decade (a negative real policy rate) and the long end is capped with the term premium near zero, so the curve is flat (10-year about 1.3 pt over the 1-year), reached by 2028 and held as a level. Nominal growth 1 pt above base (inflation, not real growth); the primary balance is held, because repression substitutes for consolidation; tier 1 at its middle pace with the longer WAM and tight spread as captive banks absorb it. For Germany, France and Italy this is an ECB-bloc case, not a national option; Australia gets a shallower cap; China already runs this curve. United States: the Fed holds the front end down (1-year 1.9, 2-year 2.2 in 2028) but cannot hold the long end, which sits where the bear puts it (10-year 5.9, 30-year 6.5, kept as a spread over market forwards), so the curve steepens sharply; the primary balance glides to zero by 2030 and is held there, and the Treasury leans on the capped front end, with bills rising to 80% of gross issuance from about 65%. Bondholders pay: a 10-year near 3.3% against 3.5–4% inflation.

Country	Growth, %/yr nominal (real + inflation)	Primary balance, % GDP 2027 / 2030 / 2036	Curve 2028 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Curve 2036 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Tier 1 (fiscal blocks)
United States	6.3 (2.3 + 4.0)	+3.9 / +0.0 / +0.0	1.9 / 5.9 / 6.5	1.9 / 6.1 / 6.5	—
France*	3.6 (1.0 + 2.6)	+2.6 / +2.6 / +2.6	1.8 / 2.5 / 2.7	1.8 / 2.5 / 2.7	CADES, Unédic, ACOSS, 8% of GDP: growth +3.2%/yr; WAM 5y; spread +10 bp
Italy*	3.9 (0.8 + 3.1)	-0.9 / -0.9 / -0.9	1.9 / 2.7 / 2.9	1.9 / 2.7 / 2.9	CDP, FS, 2% of GDP: growth +4.0%/yr; WAM 7y; spread +20 bp
United Kingdom	5.9 (1.3 + 4.6)	+1.2 / +1.2 / +1.2	1.9 / 3.4 / 3.7	1.9 / 3.4 / 3.7	—
China	5.0 (5.2 – 0.2)	+4.1 / +4.1 / +4.1	1.2 / 1.7 / 2.1	1.5 / 1.8 / 2.1	local govt + LGFV, 80% of GDP: growth LGB +16%, LGFV -3%; WAM 8y; spread +52 bp
Australia	5.8 (1.8 + 4.0)	+0.9 / +0.9 / +0.9	2.0 / 3.7 / 4.1	2.0 / 3.7 / 4.1	states, 23% of GDP: growth +10.7%/yr; WAM 9y; spread +41 bp
Canada	5.9 (1.9 + 3.9)	+0.2 / +0.2 / +0.2	1.1 / 2.4 / 2.7	1.1 / 2.4 / 2.7	provinces, 30% of GDP: growth +4.8%/yr; WAM 14y; spread +47 bp
Germany*	4.5 (0.4 + 4.1)	+2.4 / +2.4 / +2.4	1.3 / 2.0 / 2.2	1.3 / 2.0 / 2.2	Länder, 14% of GDP: growth +0.2%/yr; WAM 8y; spread +26 bp
Denmark	5.5 (2.5 + 3.0)	-0.5 / -0.5 / -0.5	1.2 / 1.9 / 2.1	1.2 / 1.9 / 2.1	—

Monetary dominance (United States only): the Volcker template

United States only, the Volcker template of 1979–98. The Fed holds policy restrictive and the curve flat through 2030 (1-year 5.6%, 2-year 5.5%, 10-year 5.6%, 30-year 5.9% from 2028, kept as a spread over market forwards) until inflation is beaten; the disinflation recession costs 1 pt of real growth and the deficit widens 1.5 pt of GDP by 2030 to support the economy. From 2031 the economy recovers (real +0.7) with inflation 1.5 pt lower, credibility lets yields fall to a terminal curve by 2032 (2.5 / 2.7 / 3.5 / 3.9, held), and the budget is reversed to a 1% surplus by 2036. Compared with the 1980s the starting debt ratio is twice as high, so the four restrictive years cost far more interest before the relief arrives.

Country	Growth, %/yr nominal (real + inflation)	Primary balance, % GDP 2027 / 2030 / 2036	Curve 2028 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Curve 2036 1Y / 10Y / 30Y	Tier 1 (fiscal blocks)
United States	3.8 (1.3 + 2.5) → 4.5 (3.0 + 1.5)	+5.6 / +6.7 / -1.0	5.6 / 5.6 / 5.9	2.5 / 3.5 / 3.9	—

Sources

Every number in this deck traces to one of the inputs below. Model code: debt_model.py (cohort roll-forward engine, validated line by line against US_Debt_Model_v4.xlsx), build_inputs.py (turns the Bloomberg pulls into the input files), run_scenarios.py (scenario definitions), tier1_overlay.py (sub-sovereign blocks), scenario_lines.py and then_vs_now.py (these charts). Snapshot date 16 October 2026 unless stated.

Debt stock, coupons and maturity ladders (2026 and 2016 vintages)

- Bloomberg SRCH pulls of every live central-government bond and bill per country (data/bloomberg/grid_*.xlsx, not redistributed): amount outstanding, coupon, maturity, type. 2026 pulls dated 16 Oct 2026; 2016 pulls dated 30 Sep 2016 (US), 31 Mar 2016 (UK, Canada), 30 Jun 2016 (Australia) and end-2016 for the rest. Issue dates are not in the pull and are estimated from market conventions and the chronological order of CUSIP / SEDOL / ISIN codes, anchored on the 2016 pull.

- Issuance composition = lines opened in the last two years by original tenor (Australia: inferred from the maturity profile). Average cost of the stock = coupon-weighted on coupon debt plus bills at the 1-year rate. US pull excludes TIPS and FRNs; CB holdings ignored.

Yield curves and term premia

- On-the-run government yields, 16 Oct 2026 (data/bloomberg/grid_xzbzwrw2.xlsx) for the US, Canada, UK, Germany, France and Italy. Short end from public sources, mid-Oct 2026: policy rates (Fed 3.75–4.00, BoC 2.25, BoE 3.75, ECB deposit 2.50, Danmarks Nationalbank 2.10, RBA 4.60, PBoC 7-day reverse repo 1.40) and 1-year bills (US 1y CMT 16 Oct; Canada 1y bill 14 Oct; UK ~1y gilt 19 Oct; 12m Bubill 12 Oct; 12m BTF 19 Oct; 12m BOT mid-Oct; China 1y CGB 20 Oct).

- Curves not in the yields file: China from the ChinaBond CGB curve, 20 Oct 2026; Denmark 2y and 10y quotes of 19 Oct 2026 with 1y, 5y and 30y interpolated; Australia 3y/5y/10y of 15 Oct 2026, 30y = 10y plus the early-October 30–10 spread, 1y interpolated.

- 2016 spot curves: user-supplied table (overnight, 2y, 5y, 10y, long bond mapped to 30y; 1y interpolated).

- Term premia (5y and 10y, 2016 and 2026): user's OIS decomposition workbook for the US, Canada and UK. Euro members and Denmark built as EUR OIS term premium plus the Bund swap spread plus the 10-year sovereign spread versus Bunds (Eurostat convergence yields Dec 2016: OAT +50 bp, BTP +164 bp, DGB +14 bp; Oct 2026: OAT +150.8 bp, BTP +112.4 bp, DGB –17.6 bp). Australia set equal to Canada by instruction. China a judgment estimate anchored on the CGB-versus-policy-rate gap. (data/bloomberg/country_macro_comparison.xlsx, tabs Country Data, TP Build, Notes & Sources.)

Fiscal balances and GDP

- General-government fiscal balances: IMF World Economic Outlook, October 2026 (2026 values are projections; UK 2026 from the April 2026 Fiscal Monitor; US and UK 2016 via FRED). Primary deficit = IMF balance less the model's own interest. Where tier 1 exists the sovereign runs on a central balance = general government less the tier-1 sector's own 2026 balance (from the tier-1 files).

- Nominal GDP, local currency: World Bank WDI, GDP current LCU (NY.GDP.MKTP.CN), 2015, 2016, 2024 and 2025; 2026 extrapolated at the 2025 growth rate. Base nominal growth = average of the 2016–25 CAGR and 2025.

Tier-1 (sub-sovereign and quasi-sovereign) debt

- data/tier1/*.csv, built from issuer disclosures 2016–2026: Canadian provincial financing authorities (Ontario, Quebec, Alberta, BC: total debt, budget balance, WAM), Australian state treasury corporations (NSW TCorp, TCV, QTC, WATC), Chinese Ministry of Finance local-government bond data and LGFV bond buckets by rating, German Länder debt statistics (securities, Schuldschein and loans), French agencies (CADES, Unédic, ACOSS; SFIL/CAFFIL, Bpifrance, AFL, IDFM as exposure variants), Italian CDP, FS, regional sinkers and CDP postal savings. Spreads: through-cycle and current (Oct 2026) over the sovereign curve. Method notes in data/tier1/tier1_model_notes.pdf.

- LGFV bank and trust loans (~RMB 42tn) are hardcoded from the notes; no securities screen captures them.

- Starting effective interest rates (latest published interest paid / average debt): Ontario 3.3, Quebec 3.7, Alberta 3.1, BC 3.2; NSW 3.7, Victoria 4.6, Queensland 3.8, WA 3.3; MoF local-government bonds ~3.1; LGFV buckets ~3.6 / 4.3 / 5.2, loans ~4.5; NRW 1.8 and city-states 1.6; CADES 1.9, Unédic 1.4, ACOSS ~ESTR + 8 bp; SFIL/Bpifrance 2.4; CDP bonds and FS 3.0; CDP postal 2.8 all-in.

Scenario settings

• Bull terminal curves (2032), bear curves (2028), repression curves (2028), growth and deficit rules and the tier-1 bull / bear settings: specified by the author of this deck (run_scenarios.py, tier1_overlay.py). China's cases and the ECB-bloc flag for repression likewise.

The 2022-against-2026 chart

• US Treasury, Monthly Statement of the Public Debt and Average Interest Rates on marketable securities, 31 Dec 2022 (total marketable 2.32%)

• Department of Finance Canada, Debt Management Report 2022-23: market debt C$1,259.9bn, average rate 2.28%

• DMO Quarterly Review Jan-Mar 2023 (gilts £2,308bn uplifted nominal + T-bills £70bn); rate = ONS central-government debt interest 2022-23 (£111.6bn) less the RPI capital uplift on index-linked gilts (~2.6% of GDP, OBR) over the portfolio: estimate, about 2.0%

• AFT, dette negociable de l'Etat fin 2022 €2,278bn; Cour des comptes / Senat, charge de la dette 2022 €49.5bn of which indexation €15.53bn

• MEF, Rapporto sul debito pubblico 2022: titoli di Stato in circolazione €2,289.2bn; costo medio di cassa 2022 2.14%

• Finanzagentur, Kreditaufnahmebericht 2022: Umlaufvolumen €1,877.4bn, Eigenbestand €202.3bn; average interest rate 1.15% at end-2022 (IW Koeln)

• Danmarks Nationalbank, Central government borrowing and debt 2022: domestic debt DKK 628.9bn, interest on domestic debt DKK 9.3bn

• AOFM Annual Report 2021-22: AGS A$895bn at 30 June 2022, interest expense A$18.75bn

• Ministry of Finance, 2022 central final accounts: CGB balance RMB 25,869bn, debt interest expenditure RMB 652.4bn

• World Bank WDI, GDP current LCU (NY.GDP.MKTP.CN), 2022

• Tier-1 2022 stocks from the data/tier1 files; 2022 effective rates: provinces 3.30% (est.; Ontario 3.2% effective rate FY2022-23 (OFA)); semis 2.20% (est.; NSW TCorp average cost of debt 2.1% at 30 Jun 2022); LGB 3.40% (est.; 2022 LGB issuance averaged 3.02% (MoF), older vintages higher); LGFV AAA 4.00% (est.); LGFV AAplus 4.70% (est.); LGFV AA below 5.60% (est.); LGFV loans 5.00% (est.; LPR-based); Laender 1.30% (est.; Bundesbank Laenderfinanzen); CADES 1.29% (CADES average financing rate end-2022); UNEDIC 0.49% (Unedic cost of financing 2022); ACOSS 0.00% (est.; bill funding at zero / negative rates in 2022); core 2.50% (est.); LGFV loans 38,000 RMB bn (est.).

• 2026 is the model's own base-case starting point (SCENARIO_LINES.csv), not an external figure.